



SweetTreats Bakery

PROPOSAL CONTENT

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

Organization Overview (1).....2

Website Goals & Objectives (2).....3

Current Website Analysis (3).....4

Proposed Website Features & Functionality (4).....5

Design and User Experience (5).....7

Technical Requirements (6).....9

Timeline & Milestones (7).....10

Budget (8).....12

References.....13

Organisation Overview (1)

At **SweetTreats Bakery**, we believe every bite should be a moment of joy. Since 1999, our ovens have been crafting more than just desserts — we bake memories. From the first whiff of buttery croissants fresh at dawn to the last crumb of a midnight cupcake craving, we turn everyday moments into something extraordinary.

Our Story

What began as a tiny corner shop with a single oven has blossomed into a beloved community hub for sugar-dusted dreams. Founded by master baker **Silindile Mnisi**, SweetTreats started with a simple mission: craft irresistible treats that taste like home. Over the years, our dedication to quality, creativity, and heartfelt service has never wavered. Today, our passionate team of bakers still follows Silindile's original recipes — now with a sprinkle of modern magic to delight every generation.

Mission Statement

To bring warmth, happiness, and connection to our community through freshly baked goods made with love, quality ingredients, and a touch of creativity.

Vision Statement

To become the most trusted and cherished bakery in the region, where every customer feels like family and every bite feels like home.

Target Audience

SweetTreats Bakery serves a diverse audience of dessert lovers — from busy professionals looking for a quick coffee and pastry, to families celebrating life's milestones, to students grabbing a sweet treat between classes. We cater to anyone who values fresh, handcrafted bakery items and a welcoming, friendly atmosphere.

Website Goals and Objectives (2)

The SweetTreats Bakery website has been designed to extend the warmth and charm of our physical store into the digital space, allowing customers to connect with our brand anytime, anywhere. The site serves as both an information hub and an online experience that reflects the bakery's values of quality, creativity, and community.

Goals

Increase Brand Awareness – Showcase the bakery's story, products, and values to a wider online audience.

Drive Foot Traffic to the Physical Store – Encourage local customers to visit in person through promotions, seasonal offers, and event announcements.

Generate Online Orders and Enquiries – Allow customers to place orders for cakes, pastries, and catering services through the website's contact or order forms.

Engage and Build Customer Loyalty – Provide engaging content such as baking tips, seasonal menus, and customer stories to keep visitors returning.

Expand Marketing Reach – Integrate with social media to attract followers and drive traffic between platforms.

Objectives & Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

Objective	KPI (How Success Will Be Measured)	Target Timeline
1. Increase website traffic	Number of unique visitors per month (tracked via analytics tools)	+30% within 6 months
2. Generate more customer leads	Number of completed contact/order forms	50+ new leads per month
3. Boost online sales	Number of online orders completed via the site	20% increase in 3 months
4. Increase engagement	Average session duration and repeat visitor rate	3+ minutes per session, 25% returning visitors
5. Grow social media following via website links	Click-through rate from website to social media	+15% in follower count over 4 months

Current Website Analysis (3)

The current SweetTreats Bakery website successfully presents essential business information in a clear and accessible format. Built using HTML, the site includes well-structured sections such as the menu, About Us, and Contact Information. Customers can easily learn about the bakery, browse available products, and find ways to connect — whether to leave a review, lodge a complaint, or explore sponsorship opportunities.

Strengths

Clear and Complete Information – All core sections (menu, About Us, contact details) are implemented effectively.

User-Friendly Navigation – Simple HTML layout ensures information is easy to find.

Visual Appeal – Use of images helps to showcase products and enhance the customer's experience.

Functional Contact Methods – Multiple options for reaching the bakery are clearly presented, supporting customer engagement.

Weaknesses

Lack of Responsiveness – The website is not yet optimised for viewing on different screen sizes (e.g., mobile devices, tablets).

No Interactive Features – The absence of JavaScript limits dynamic elements such as animations, dropdown menus, or interactive forms.

Basic Styling – Without CSS, the site's visual design is limited, and the user experience could be further enhanced.

Areas for Improvement

Implement Responsive Design with CSS – Use flexible layouts, media queries, and styling to ensure the site adapts to different devices.

Integrate JavaScript for Interactivity – Add subtle animations, interactive buttons, and enhanced form functionality to improve user engagement.

Enhance Branding Through Styling – Apply consistent colour schemes, typography, and spacing to better reflect the bakery's identity.

Overall, the website provides a solid foundation with clear structure and content. With the addition of CSS for responsive design and JavaScript for interactivity, it can evolve into a more visually engaging and user-friendly online platform.

Proposed Website Features & Functionality (4)

To enhance user experience and better align with SweetTreats Bakery's business goals, the proposed website will incorporate essential pages and improved functionality. The design will ensure that visitors can easily navigate, access information, and engage with the bakery online.

Essential Pages

Home Page

Attractive landing page showcasing featured products, current promotions, and a welcoming message.

Clear navigation menu leading to other sections of the site.

About Us Page

Story of SweetTreats Bakery, including its history, mission, and vision.

Photos of the bakery, team members, and behind-the-scenes baking process.

Products & Services Page

Full menu of baked goods with descriptions and images.

Information about custom cake orders, catering services, and seasonal offerings.

Contact Page

Contact form for general enquiries, reviews, and complaints.

Sponsorship request form for potential partners.

Map integration to display the bakery's location and opening hours.

Desired Functionality

Responsive Design – Ensure the website adjusts smoothly to mobile, tablet, and desktop devices.

Interactive Elements – Use JavaScript for image sliders, animations, and hover effects to make the site visually engaging.

Online Ordering Capability – Allow customers to place orders directly from the website, with options for pick-up or delivery.

Search Function – Enable visitors to quickly find specific products or information.

Social Media Integration – Display live feeds or clickable icons linking to the bakery's social profiles.

SEO Optimisation – Apply search engine best practices to improve visibility and increase traffic.

The proposed features aim to transform the SweetTreats Bakery website from a simple HTML-based site into an engaging, interactive, and customer-friendly platform that supports both online and offline business growth.

Design & User Experience (5)

The design of the SweetTreats Bakery website reflects the warmth, charm, and inviting nature of the bakery itself. Our goal is to create a visually appealing and intuitive online experience that captures the essence of our brand while making it easy and enjoyable for visitors to explore.

Design Aesthetic and Branding

Colour Scheme:

The website's palette features soft, comforting colours inspired by our bakery's cozy atmosphere. Pastel pink evokes sweetness and friendliness; cream and soft beige provide a warm, neutral backdrop; warm brown hints at freshly baked goods like bread and chocolate; and accent rose adds a touch of elegance and vibrancy to key elements. This combination creates a harmonious, inviting look that appeals to our diverse audience.

Typography:

Clean, easy-to-read fonts will be used to balance style with functionality. A combination of a modern sans-serif font for body text and a friendly, slightly playful serif or script font for headings and accent text will reflect both professionalism and approachability.

Layout and Design Approach:

The site will adopt a clean, uncluttered layout with generous spacing to ensure content is digestible and navigation straightforward. Visual hierarchy will be established using size, colour accents, and imagery, guiding users' eyes to important information and calls to action. High-quality images of bakery products will be prominently displayed to stimulate appetite and engagement.

User Experience (UX) Considerations

Navigation Bars:

A fixed, top navigation bar will allow visitors to easily access main pages such as Home, About Us, Products & Services, and Contact at any time. Clear labelling and hover effects in the accent rose colour will enhance usability.

Responsive Design:

The website will be fully responsive, adapting seamlessly to different screen sizes from mobile phones to desktops to ensure a consistent, pleasant user experience.

Intuitive Layout:

Content sections will be logically ordered, making it effortless for users to find information. For example, the Home page will feature quick links to popular products and special offers, while the Contact page will have clearly marked forms and location info.

Interactive Elements:

Subtle animations and hover effects will provide visual feedback and keep users engaged without overwhelming the senses.

Accessibility:

The design will ensure sufficient contrast for readability, alt text for images, and keyboard navigability to make the site accessible to all visitors.

Together, these design and UX choices ensure that SweetTreats Bakery's website is not only beautiful but also functional and welcoming—reflecting the brand's promise of delightful moments with every bite.

Technical Requirements (6)

The development and maintenance of the SweetTreats Bakery website require specific technical considerations to ensure functionality, accessibility, and scalability.

Hosting and Domain Name Requirements

Domain Name: The website will require a registered domain name that reflects the bakery's brand (e.g., www.sweettreatsbakery.co.za).

Hosting: A reliable web hosting service is necessary to store website files and ensure consistent uptime. Shared hosting is sufficient for initial deployment, with the option to upgrade to VPS or dedicated hosting as traffic increases.

Bandwidth and Storage: Adequate bandwidth to handle expected traffic and sufficient storage for HTML files, images, and potential future media content.

Security: SSL certificate installation for secure browsing (HTTPS).

Programming Languages

HTML: Used as the core structure of the website, providing the foundation for all pages and content.

CSS (Planned): Will be implemented to enhance styling, ensure responsive design, and improve overall user experience.

JavaScript (Planned): Will be added to create interactive elements such as animations, dynamic navigation menus, and form validation.

Frameworks and Libraries

No frameworks or libraries have been used in the current version of the website. Future enhancements may incorporate libraries such as jQuery (for simplified JavaScript operations) or Bootstrap (for responsive, mobile-first design).

By combining a solid hosting plan, a suitable domain name, and core web technologies, the SweetTreats Bakery website will remain functional, secure, and ready for future upgrades to improve interactivity and visual appeal.

Timeline & Milestones (7)

The development of the SweetTreats Bakery website is structured into three main phases, aligning with the assignment's submission deadlines. Each phase focuses on building upon the previous stage to create a fully functional, visually appealing, and user-friendly website.

Phase 1 – HTML Structure

- **Due Date:** 27 August 2025
- **Tasks:**
 - Develop the core HTML structure for all planned pages (Home, About Us, Products & Services, Contact).
 - Ensure all text content and images are in place.
 - Verify proper linking between pages and basic navigation functionality.
- **Milestone:** Fully functional HTML-based website with all required sections and accurate content placement.

Phase 2 – Styling & Responsiveness

- **Due Date:** 26 September 2025
- **Tasks:**
 - Implement CSS to improve the website's aesthetic appeal, following the SweetTreats Bakery colour palette and branding.
 - Apply responsive design principles to ensure compatibility with various devices and screen sizes.
 - Test usability on desktop, tablet, and mobile.
- **Milestone:** Fully styled and responsive website that adapts seamlessly to different devices.

Phase 3 – Full Functionality & Optimisation

- **Due Date:** To be announced (final submission date)

- **Tasks:**

- Integrate JavaScript for interactivity (animations, form validation, dynamic navigation).
- Implement SEO best practices to improve search engine visibility.
- Conduct final compatibility and performance testing across devices and browsers.

- **Milestone:** Fully functional, interactive, and optimised website capable of providing an excellent user experience on any device.

This phased approach ensures steady progress, allowing for thorough testing and refinement at each stage while meeting all assignment requirements.

Budget (8)

The following budget outlines estimated costs for developing, deploying, and maintaining the SweetTreats Bakery website. Prices are based on average market rates in South Africa and may vary depending on the service providers chosen.

Item	Description	Estimated Cost (ZAR)
Domain Registration	Annual registration of a .co.za domain name	R120 – R200 per year
Web Hosting	Shared hosting plan with SSL certificate for security	R1,200 – R1,800 per year
Website Development	Initial creation using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript; includes design, coding, and testing	R5,000 – R8,000 (once-off if self-developed, otherwise paid to developer)
Graphics & Images	Professional product photography or stock images	R1,000 – R2,500 (once-off)
SEO Implementation	Optimisation for search engines (keywords, metadata, site speed)	R1,500 – R3,000 (once-off)
JavaScript Functionality	Adding animations, form validation, and interactive elements	R1,500 – R3,000 (once-off)
Maintenance & Updates	Content updates, security patches, backups	R500 – R1,200 per month (R6,000 – R14,400 per year)

Estimated Total (First Year): R15,320 – R28,900

Estimated Annual Maintenance (After First Year): R6,000 – R14,400

This budget assumes a mix of self-development and minimal outsourcing. If all tasks are outsourced to professional developers and designers, costs could increase significantly. Conversely, a fully self-developed project would lower costs but require additional personal time investment.

References

AI Assistance Disclosure

This assignment was developed with the support of OpenAI's ChatGPT language model. The AI was utilized to generate, enhance, and organize content based on the information and guidelines provided. All AI-generated material has been clearly acknowledged and cited in the reference list in accordance with academic integrity policies. The final responsibility for the content and accuracy of the assignment remains with the author.

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References for AI-Generated Images

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Google Play Store badge (189x56) Copilot. (2025, August 13). *Google Play Store badge in SweetTreats color palette* [AI-generated image]. Microsoft Copilot.

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Majestically falling pastries Copilot. (2025, August 13). *Floating pastries against a soft pink sky for homepage visual* [AI-generated image]. Microsoft Copilot.

Blueberry pie (logo-free) Copilot. (2025, August 13). *Golden crust blueberry pie with bakery storefront background* [AI-generated image]. Microsoft Copilot.

Dear Lecturer, I would like to inform you that all the images included in my Portfolio of Evidence (Part 1) were AI-generated by me using Microsoft Copilot. These visuals were created specifically to align with the theme and content of my project. Please let me know if you require any additional details or references.

Kind regards,

Slindile Mnisi